While things might have been settling down for Britain in Persia, 1922 was still an eventful year for officials in London. One of the most important occurrences at this time was the resignation of Edwin Montagu as secretary of state for India, highlighting as it did the broader struggle between London and Delhi over Britain's foreign relations. By 1922, this struggle was focused on the matter of Turkey. Indeed, Turkey was one subject the secretary of state for India and the viceroy could agree on. From the outset, Montagu and Chelmsford (and then Reading) had never missed an opportunity to impress upon the Cabinet the importance to India of having a stable relationship with Turkey. Caliphate agitation had remained steady in India, and the viceroy and secretary of state had no doubt that Britain's dealings with Turkey had been contributing to Muslim dissatisfaction with the empire. In February 1922, Reading made one more plea to London to take into account India's views. With the Conference of London proving unsuccessful in bringing about a resolution on the Turkish issue, there was still conflict between the Kemalist and Greek forces. In early 1922, Curzon was therefore preparing to head to Paris to try to bring about an Allied mediation between these two belligerents.[69] In view of this, the Indian government composed a telegram on 28 February once again explaining the intensity of feeling in India regarding the necessity of revising the Treaty of Sèvres. Reading pointed out that 'as the greatest power in the Mahomedan world, Great Britain must, no less than the other Allies, be sympathetic towards Moslem feeling and ready to take active steps on behalf of Islam'.

Although there was nothing particularly new in this plea from Delhi, the crucial point is that the viceroy asked to be allowed to publish the telegram, presumably to demonstrate to the Indian public his support for the Muslim cause.[70] On 6 March, without consulting the Cabinet, Montagu consented to publication.[71] Bypassing the Cabinet in this way and taking it upon himself to allow the Indian government to speak publicly on this matter was to prove a serious error on the part of the secretary of state. On 9 March when Lloyd George found out about the telegrams he summoned Montagu to his office and asked for his resignation: